Scribble to Digital

Team ID : SWTID-2026-3490
Team Size : 4
Team Leader : NITHISHA R
Team Member : DHATCHAYANI K
Team Member : RAJ GOWTHAM P
Team Member : MOHAMMED RIYAS T

Introduction

Converting handwritten notes into digital format is a common challenge faced by students and professionals. Poor lighting, unclear handwriting, and mixed content (notes + tasks) reduce productivity and require manual rewriting.

Scribble to Digital is an AI-powered system that converts messy handwritten notes into clean, structured digital text. The system enhances uploaded images, extracts text using OCR, and applies Generative AI to correct grammar and automatically extract To-Do tasks.

The application is developed using **Streamlit** as the frontend framework and Python as the backend processing engine.

Use Case Scenarios

Scenario 1: Handwritten Note Digitization with Image Enhancement

Users upload a photo of messy handwritten notes through the Streamlit interface. The system internally enhances the image using OpenCV by converting it to grayscale, increasing brightness and contrast, reducing noise, and applying thresholding techniques.

After enhancement, the improved image is passed to the OCR engine for accurate text extraction. This process ensures better readability and higher text recognition accuracy even for low-quality or unclear handwriting.

The output includes:

- Raw OCR extracted text
- Improved clarity for further AI processing

Scenario 2: Intelligent Text Correction and Contextual Reconstruction

After OCR extraction, the raw text may contain spelling mistakes, missing letters, and broken words due to handwriting variations.

The Generative AI model analyzes the extracted text and:

- Corrects spelling errors
- Improves grammar and sentence structure
- Reconstructs incomplete or unclear words using contextual understanding
- Formats the text into readable paragraphs

This ensures that messy handwritten content is converted into professional and well-structured digital text.

Scenario 3: Automatic To-Do Extraction and Task Identification

Handwritten notes often contain a mixture of general information and actionable tasks. Identifying tasks manually can be time-consuming.

The AI system analyses sentence intent and:

- Detects task-oriented statements
- Extracts actionable items
- Organizes them into a structured bullet-point To-Do list

This allows users to quickly identify important tasks separately from general notes, improving productivity and task management.

Architecture Overview

Scribble to Digital is an intelligent AI-powered web application designed to convert handwritten notes into clean, structured digital text. The platform is built using the Streamlit framework, enabling rapid development of an interactive user interface. The system integrates:

- Streamlit for frontend and application logic
- OpenCV for image preprocessing and enhancement
- OCR Engine (Tesseract/EasyOCR) for text extraction
- Google Gemini 2.5 Flash (Generative AI) for contextual correction, formatting, and task extraction

The platform processes handwritten images, enhances clarity, extracts text, corrects errors using AI, and optionally generates structured outputs such as formatted notes and to-do lists.

Core Technologies

- **Streamlit**: Interactive web application framework for UI, file uploads, and result display
- **Google Gemini 2.5 Flash**: AI model for contextual understanding, grammar correction, and smart task extraction
- **OpenCV**: Image preprocessing (grayscale conversion, noise removal, thresholding)
- **OCR (Tesseract/EasyOCR)**: Converts enhanced handwritten images into raw digital text
- **Python**: Core programming language
- **ReportLab / Python-DOCX**: Optional export to PDF and Word formats

Component-Wise Architecture

Component	Description
Streamlit Frontend UI	Providesasimple web interface for users to upload handwritten images. Displaysenhanced images, extracted text, corrected content, and to-do lists dynamically.
Image Processing Layer (OpenCV)	Enhances uploaded images by converting to grayscale, adjusting brightness/contrast, reducing noise, and applying thresholding to improve OCR accuracy.
OCR Layer	Extracts raw text from the processed image. Handles handwriting recognition and converts image content into machine-readable text.
Generative AI Layer (Gemini 2.5 Flash)	Processes extracted text to: • Correct spelling and grammar • Reconstruct incomplete words • Format into structured paragraphs • Extract actionable to-do items
Export Module	Converts AI-processed content into downloadable formats such as PDF or Word documents.

Pre-requisites

1. Google AI Studio Account Setup – To generate Gemini API Key
2. Python 3.8+ Installed
3. Streamlit Framework Installed
4. Required Python Libraries
    - opencv-python
    - pytesseract / easyocr
    - google-generativeai

- pillow
- reportlab (for PDF export)
- python-docx (for Word export)

5. Tesseract OCR Installed (if using pytesseract)

Project Workflow

1. Gemini AI Setup & Initialization

Activity1.1:SetupGoogleAIStudiowithGemini API

- Create or sign in to Google AI Studio account
- Generate API key for Gemini model access
- Enable Gemini 2.5 Flash model
- Test API integration using a sample prompt

Activity 1.2: Configure API Keys and Environment

- Store GEMINI_API_KEY securely in .env file
- Load environment variables using python-dotenv
- Configure model parameters:
  - Temperature
  - Max output tokens
  - Response format
- Validate API connectivity inside Streamlit app

Activity 1.3: Design AI Prompts for Note Processing

- Create prompt template for:
  - Grammar correction
  - Sentence reconstruction
  - Formatting messy text into structured paragraphs
- Designseparate prompt for:
  - To-do task extraction
  - Task prioritization (if needed)
- Testprompt effectiveness with sample handwritten text

2.CoreFunctionality Development

Activity2.1:DesignStreamlitAppStructure

- Create modularproject structure:

Configure Streamlit layout:

- Title & description
- File uploader
- Processing buttons
- Output display sections

Activity 2.2: Implement Image Processing Module

- Accept image upload (JPG/PNG)
- Apply preprocessing using OpenCV:
  - o Convert to grayscale
  - o Adjust brightness & contrast
  - o Remove noise
  - o Apply thresholding
- Display enhanced image preview in Streamlit

Activity 2.3: Implement OCR Extraction

- Integrate Tesseract or EasyOCR
- Extract raw handwritten text
- Clean unnecessary symbols
- Display raw OCR output for comparison

Activity 2.4:AI-Based Contextual Processing

- Send OCR text to Gemini API
- Perform:
  - o Grammar correction
  - o Sentence completion
  - o Context-based word guessing
  - o Formatting into structured notes
- Extract action items separately
- Return:
  - o Clean digital text
  - o Structured to-do list

3. Streamlit UI Implementation

Activity3.1: BuildInteractiveUI Components

- st.file_uploader() for image upload
- st.image() for displaying uploaded & enhanced image
- st.button() for processing steps
- st.spinner() for loading indication
- st.text_area() for displaying extracted text

Activity 3.2: Display Structured Results

- Section 1: Enhanced Image
- Section 2: Raw OCR Text
- Section 3: AI-Corrected Digital Notes
- Section 4: Extracted To-Do Tasks (bullet format) Optional:
- Checkbox to show/hide raw OCR
- Download buttons for final output

- **Activity 3.3: Add Export Functionality**
- Generatedownloadable:
  - PDF(usingReport Lab)
  - Word file (using python-docx)
  - Use st.download_button()
  - Allow preview before download

4. Testing & Optimization

Activity 4.1: Functional Testing

- Testwith:
  - Clear handwriting
  - Messy handwriting
  - Mixed text + tasks
  - Bullet points
- Validate OCR accuracy
- Validate AI corrections

Activity 4.2: Evaluate AI Response Quality

- Check:
  - Grammar correction accuracy
  - Logical sentence flow
  - Proper formatting
  - Correct task extraction
- Ensure no hallucinated content

Activity 4.3: Performance Optimization

- Optimize imagepreprocessingsteps
- Reduce API token usage
- Add error handling for:
  - Empty image

    - API failure
    - OCR failure
- Improve prompt clarity

Activity 4.4: Ensure Export Quality

- Validate PDF formatting
- Check Word document structure
- Ensure file compatibility
- Test downloads across browsers

MILESTONE 1: Generative AI Initialization

Project: Scribble to Digital (Streamlit Framework)

In this foundational stage, the objective is to establish and configure the AI infrastructure required to power the **Scribble to Digital** application.

The platform uses **Gemini 2.5 Flash**, Google's fast and efficient multimodal model, to:

- Correct messy handwritten OCR text
- Improve grammar and sentence flow
- Reconstruct incomplete words
- Extract structured to-do tasks
- Convert handwritten notes into clean digital format

Activity 1.1: Set up Google AI Studio and Enable Gemini API

1. Sign into Google AIStudio

1. Visit: https://makersuite.google.com/app/apikey
2. Sign in with your Google account
3. Accept terms and conditions

2. Create API Key

- Click **"Create API Key"**
- Copy the generated API key
- Store it securely in a .env file

3. Select Model

Choose: **Gemini 2.5 Flash**

Model Features:

- Fast response time
- Efficient token usage
- Suitable for text correction & formatting
- Free tier supports multiple requests per minute

Best for:

- OCR text cleaning
- Contextual rewriting
- Structured note generation

Activity 1.2: Configure Environment and Test Connection (Streamlit Setup)

Step 1: Create. env File
Inside your project folder:
Step 2: Install Required Dependencies

Libraries Used:

- **streamlit** → UI framework
- **google-generativeai** → Gemini API integration
- **python-dotenv** → Load environment variables
- **opencv-python** → Image preprocessing
- **pytesseract** → OCR text extraction
- **pillow** → Image handling

Step 3: Test Gemini API Connection in Streamlit Create

a simple test inside

Activity1.3:ValidateConnectivityand Response Quality

Test Case 1: Grammar Correction Input:

Expected Output:

Test Case 2: Structured Note Formatting Input:

Expected Output:

- Formatted paragraph
- Bullet list tasks extracted

MILESTONE 2: Core Functionalities Development (Streamlit)

This milestone focuses on building the complete working application using **Streamlit + Gemini 2.5 Flash**.

The goal is to:

- Upload handwritten note images
- Extract text using OCR
- Clean & correct text using Gemini
- Extract tasks automatically
- Display structured digital output
- Enable download options

File Explorer Structure

Activity 2.1: Streamlit Initialization and Import Libraries

Configure Gemini Model

Import Required Libraries In app.py:

Activity 2.2: OCR Processing Module

Create utils/ocr_processor.py

Purpose:

- Convert image to grayscale
- Improve brightness
- Remove noise
- Extract raw OCR text

Activity2.3:GeminiAIProcessingModule

Create utils/ai_processor.py

AI Responsibilities:

- Grammar correction
- Sentence restructuring
- Context guessing
- To-Do extraction

Activity 2.4: Streamlit Main UI Logic

Inside app.py

Activity2.5:ExportFunctionality

Create utils/file_export.py

Save as TXT

In app.py:

MILESTONE 3: Backend – Flask Integration (app.py)

This milestone focuses on implementing the complete Flask backend for the **Scribble to Digital** application, including OCR processing, GenAI integration, task extraction, error handling, and export functionality.

Activity 3.1: Complete Route Definitions All

routes are properly defined with:

1. Input Validation

- Validates uploaded image file type (.jpg, .png, .jpeg)
- Checks for empty file upload
- Validates file size limit
- Ensures image can be processed

2. Error Handling

1. Handles OCR processing errors
2. Handles Gemini API failures
3. Returns proper JSON error responses
4. Prevents server crash on invalid input

3. Logging

- Logs image upload events
- Logs OCR extracted text
- Logs GenAI responses
- Logs export operations
- Debug logs for development mode

4. Response Formatting

- Structured JSON response:

Activity 3.2: Modular Architecture

Main Application Structure

Separation of Concerns

- ocr_service.py → Handles image preprocessing & Tesseract
- ai_service.py → Handles contextual correction & to-do extraction
- export_service.py → Handles file generation
- app.py → Controls routes &server startup

Flask Server Initialization (app.py)

Activity3.3:Export Implementation

Complete implementation of:

1. PDF Generation

- Clean formatted digital notes
- Structured to-do list section
- Professional layout
- Downloadable file

2. Word Document Export (.docx)

- Heading styles
- Bullet points for tasks
- Editable format

3. CSV Export (Task List)

- Task column
- Status column (Pending/Done)
- Compatible with Excel

4. File Cleanup & Management

- Temporary file storage
- Auto-delete after download
- Secure file handling

MILESTONE4:UIDevelopment

This milestone focuses on building a modern, responsive, and interactive frontend interface using Streamlit for the Scribble to Digital application.

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Activity 4.1: Landing Page Development

1.UploadNotes

-
-
-

2. Smart Correction

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3. To-Do Extraction

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-
-

Activity 4.2: Processing Page (Main Generator Page)

Input Fields:

-
-
-

UI Layout (Streamlit Flow)

Activity 4.3: UI Components Implementation (Streamlit Code Structure)

Sidebar

Home Page Layout

Processing Page Layout

Activity 4.4: Export Interface

Activity 4.5: UI Design Principles Applied

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Complete User Interaction Flow

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MILESTONE 5: Testing & Optimization

Activity 5.1: Comprehensive Testing

Test Scenarios

Test Scenario 1: Clear Handwriting

- High-resolution image
- Proper lighting
- Neatly written text

Expected Result:

- Accurate OCR text extraction
- Proper grammar correction using AI
- Correct identification of tasks

Outcome:
The system successfully extracted clean text and correctly separated action items into a todo list.

Test Scenario 2: Medium Quality Handwriting

- Slight shadows
- Minor spelling distortions
- Mixed notes and tasks

Expected Result:

- OCR extracts readable text
- AI corrects spelling using contextual logic
- Tasks are properly separated

Outcome:
The AI improved sentence clarity and successfully identified most tasks.

Test Scenario 3: Poor Quality Image

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Test Scenario 4: Notes Without Tasks

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Test Scenario 5: Bullet Point Notes

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Activity 5.2: Quality Evaluation

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-
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Activity 5.3: Performance Optimization

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Stress Testing

Edge Case Handling

- Blank image upload
- Non-text image upload
- OCR failure
- Gemini API failure
- Internet connectivity issues
- All cases were handled with appropriate error messages.

Sample code

ai_processor.py

```
import os
from dotenv import load_dotenv
load_dotenv()
genai.configure(api_key=os.getenv("GEMINI_API_KEY"))
model = genai.GenerativeModel("gemini-2.5-flash")
def process_notes(text):
    prompt = f"""
```

```
- task 1
- task 2
```

```
"""
```

file_export.py

```
import os
fromdotenvimportload_dotenv

load_dotenv()

genai.configure(api_key=os.getenv("GEMINI_API_KEY"))

model=genai.GenerativeModel("gemini-2.5-flash")


def process_notes(text):
    prompt =f"""
YouareanAIthatfixesmessy OCR text from handwritten notes.

TheOCRtextmaycontain:
- spelling mistakes
- missing letters
- broken words
- random symbols

Yourtasks:

1.Correctspellingmistakes
2.Reconstructincomplete words
3. Fix grammar
4.Convertintoclearreadable paragraphs
5.ExtractTo-Dotasksseparately

Returnoutputinthisformat:

CLEAN NOTES:
<corrected notes>

TODO TASKS:
- task 1
- task 2

OCR TEXT:
{text}
"""
    response = model.generate_content(prompt)
```

```
    return response.text
```

ocr_processor.py

```
import cv2
import pytesseract
from PIL import Image
import numpy as np

#Tesseract path (change if different)
pytesseract.pytesseract.tesseract_cmd = r"C:\Program Files\Tesseract-OCR\tesseract.exe"


defpreprocess_image(image):

    img = np.array(image)

    #Convert to grayscale
    gray = cv2.cvtColor(img, cv2.COLOR_BGR2GRAY)

    #Increase contrast
    gray = cv2.convertScaleAbs(gray, alpha=2, beta=20)

    #Remove noise
    blur = cv2.GaussianBlur(gray, (5,5), 0)

    #Thresholding
    thresh = cv2.adaptiveThreshold(
        blur,
        255,
        cv2.ADAPTIVE_THRESH_GAUSSIAN_C,
        cv2.THRESH_BINARY,
        11,
        2
    )

    return thresh


defextract_text(image):

    processed = preprocess_image(image)
```

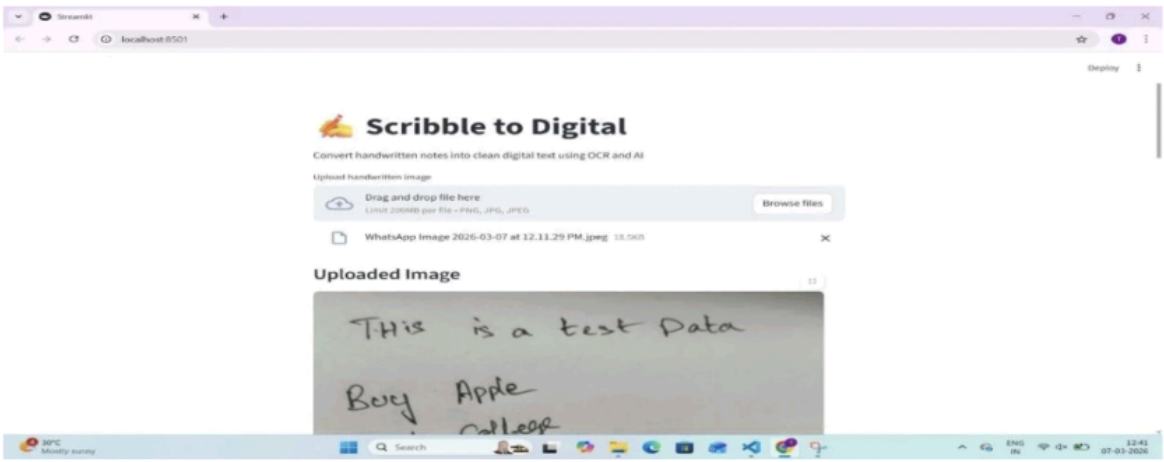
```
 config = "--oem 3 --psm 6"

    text = pytesseract.image_to_string(processed, config=config)

    return text, processed
```

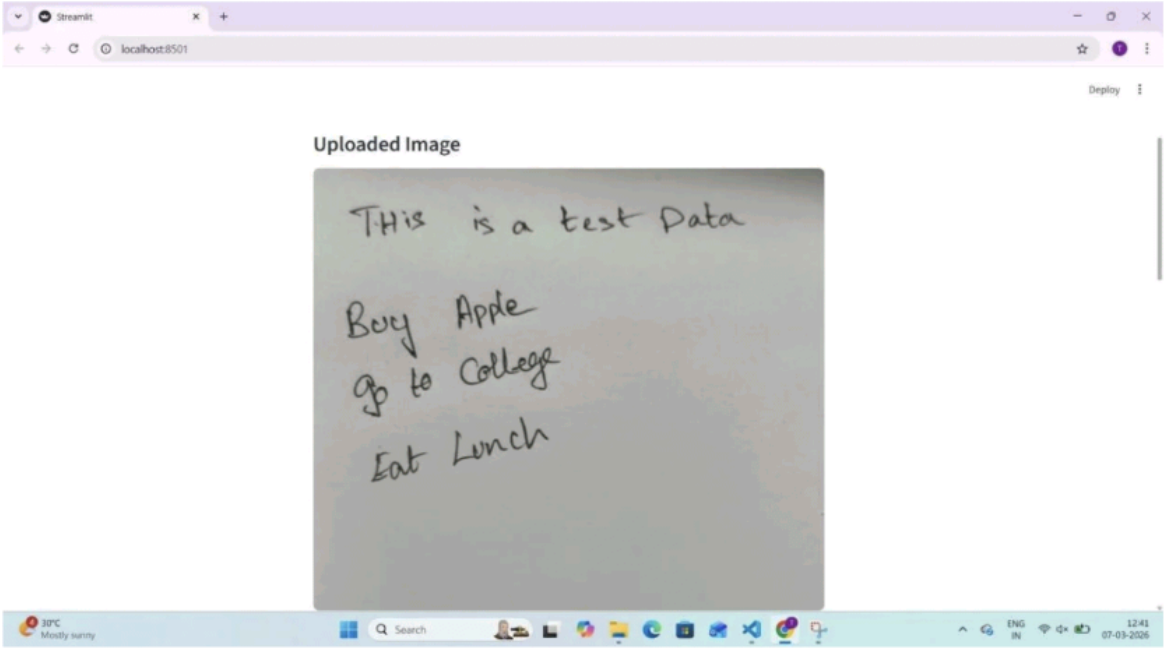
app.py

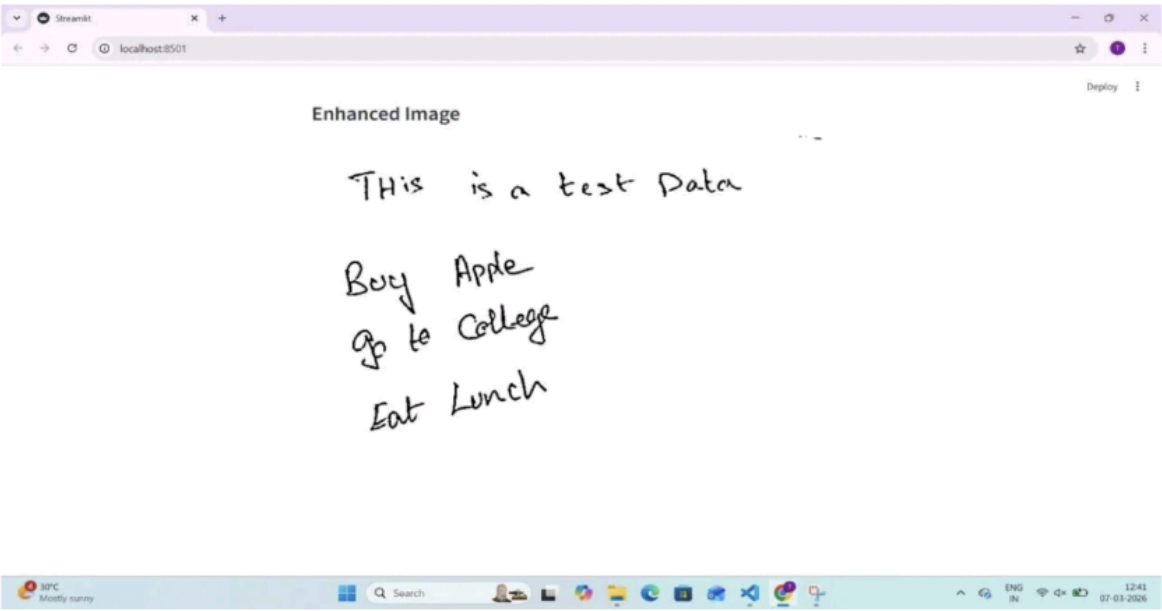
```
import streamlit as st
from PIL import Image
from utils.ocr_processor import extract_text
from utils.ai_processor import process_notes
from utils.file_export import export_txt, export_pdf, export_docx

st.title("✍️ Scribble to Digital")
st.write("Convert handwritten notes into clean digital text using OCR and AI")

uploaded_file = st.file_uploader("Upload handwritten image", type=["png","jpg","jpeg"])

if uploaded_file:

    image = Image.open(uploaded_file)

    st.subheader("Uploaded Image")
    st.image(image)

    if st.button("Process Notes"):

        with st.spinner("Processing..."):

            raw_text, enhanced = extract_text(image)

            st.subheader("Enhanced Image")
            st.image(enhanced)

            st.subheader("Raw OCR Text")
            st.text_area("", raw_text, height=150)

            ai_result = process_notes(raw_text)

            st.subheader("AI Corrected Notes & Tasks")
            st.text_area("", ai_result, height=300)
```

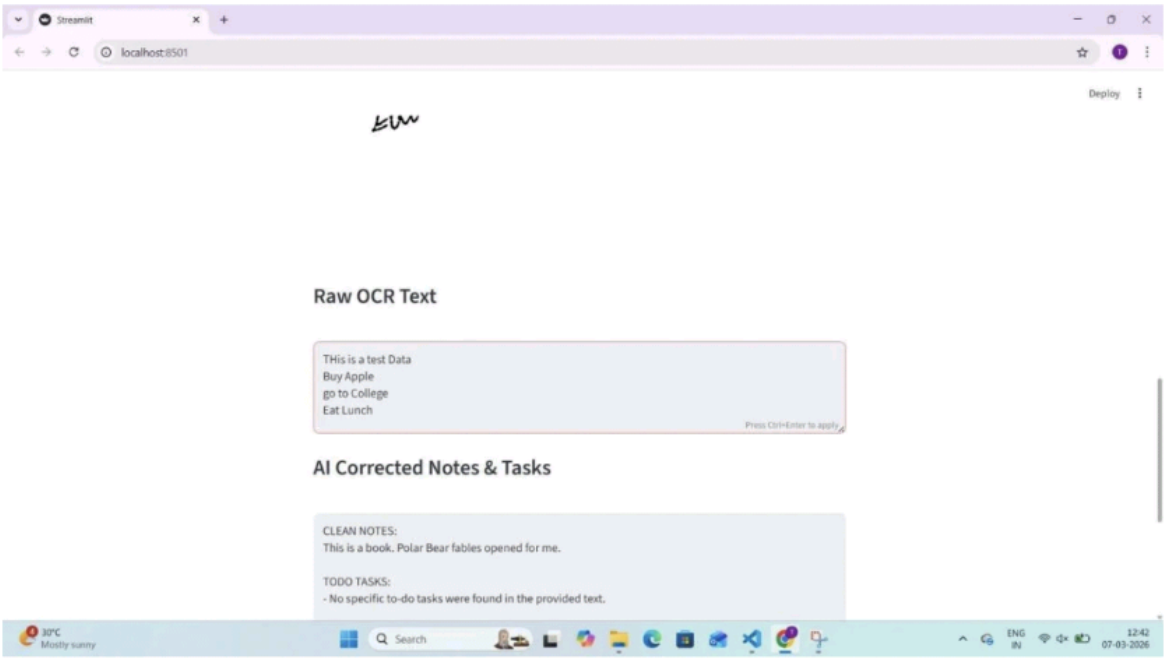
```
txt_file = export_txt(ai_result)
pdf_file = export_pdf(ai_result)
docx_file = export_docx(ai_result)

st.download_button(
    "Download TXT",
    txt_file,
    file_name="notes.txt"
)

st.download_button(
    "Download PDF",
    pdf_file,
    file_name="notes.pdf"
)

st.download_button(
"Download DOCX",
docx_file,
file_name="notes.docx"
)
```

Output




Streamlit
localhost:8501
Deploy
Uploaded Image
THis is a test Data
Buy Apple
go to College
Eat Lunch


Streamlit
localhost:8501
Deploy
Enhanced Image
THis is a test Data
Buy Apple
go to College
Eat Lunch



Conclusion

Scribble to Digital transforms traditional handwritten note-taking into an intelligent, AI-powered digital workflow. By combining OCR technology with advanced generative AI, the system accurately extracts handwritten content, enhances readability through contextual correction, and intelligently identifies actionable tasks. The integration of image preprocessing, structured AI prompts, and a responsive Streamlit frontend ensures a seamless and user-friendly experience.

From image enhancement and text recognition to contextual understanding and to-do extraction, every component of Scribble to Digital is designed with a focus on accuracy, efficiency, and reliability. The system not only digitizes messy notes but also adds value by organizing content into clean text and structured task lists, saving users time and effort.

With modular architecture, effective error handling, and optimized performance, Scribble to Digital demonstrates how AI can bridge the gap between handwritten creativity and digital productivity. Whether used by students, professionals, or teams, the application serves as a smart assistant that enhances organization, improves clarity, and streamlines everyday workflows.